

VARSHITHA KOTHAKOTA

Aspiring AI Product Manager | Product Strategy • Product Discovery • AI Products

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Final-year Computer Science (AI & Data Science) student with a portfolio of 8+ independent product case studies, teardowns, and strategy proposals spanning consumer, fintech, and AI products. Skilled at translating ambiguous problems into validated opportunities through user research, competitive analysis, PRDs, and experimentation. Seeking a Product Management / APM role to apply structured product thinking to real-world, high-scale user problems.

EDUCATION

The Apollo University

Expected Graduation: 2027

B.Tech, Computer Science Engineering (AI & Data Science) | CGPA: 9.10/10

EXPERIENCE

Community Manager & Product Operations Intern — Co-Found With Us

May 2026 – Present

- Managed the product backlog across community, growth, and content initiatives, working directly with founders to prioritize execution.
- Ran stakeholder discussions to surface operational pain points and translated findings into structured product documentation, including PRDs.
- Authored user stories and acceptance criteria used by engineering teams to scope and build features.
- Defined success metrics for experiments and maintained documentation supporting iterative, data-informed development.
- Coordinated cross-functional workflows across asynchronous, distributed teams to keep delivery on schedule.

PRODUCT PORTFOLIO

What's My Move? — AI Career Decision Platform (Featured Product)

Product Discovery • MVP Development • UX Research • Product Strategy

- Identified career decision paralysis among final-year students as a validated problem through direct user discovery.
- Designed a structured career-recommendation framework based on user interests, skills, and aspirations.
- Built and launched an interactive MVP to test core assumptions with real users prior to further investment.
- Applied personas, user journey mapping, and prioritization frameworks to drive iterative product improvements.

Portfolio Decay — Product Case Study

Product Discovery • Problem Validation • Product Thinking

- Investigated why professionals fail to keep portfolios and LinkedIn profiles current despite active project work.
- Reframed the challenge as a "Portfolio Decay" problem rather than a simple GitHub-integration problem, changing the solution direction.
- Proposed an AI-assisted workflow converting GitHub repositories into reusable professional artifacts for LinkedIn, resumes, and portfolios, with documented risks and assumptions.

Product Strategy — Way2News & FirstClub

Growth Strategy • Monetization • Differentiation

- Way2News:** Proposed three monetization opportunities using existing platform assets, including hyperlocal distribution concepts designed to improve ARPU without additional user acquisition spend.
- FirstClub:** Designed a trust-first product strategy centered on household decision support rather than delivery speed, aimed at improving differentiation, retention, and long-term customer trust.

Product Teardowns — Cursor AI & GitHub Copilot

Competitive Analysis • Retention • Monetization • PLG

- Cursor AI:** Conducted an end-to-end teardown covering onboarding, activation, aha-moment design, retention, pricing, trust architecture, and product-led growth.
- GitHub Copilot:** Analyzed competitive positioning, unit economics, and AI-native workflows against Cursor, identifying strategic risks and opportunities in the AI developer-tools market.

Product Concepts — Privacy Shield & OpsMind AI

AI Product Design • Compliance • Decision Intelligence

- **Privacy Shield (Zomato DPDPA):** Designed a privacy-first delivery experience aligned to India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, featuring scoped time-bound data access, progressive location disclosure, and transparent retention controls, backed by personas and redesigned user flows.
- **OpsMind AI:** Conceptualized an Industrial Decision Intelligence platform for manufacturing operations at ET AI Hackathon 2.0, designing explainable AI workflows and a knowledge-graph architecture for operational decision support.

RESEARCH

AI-Enhanced Clinical Decision Support Systems for Dengue and Malaria

Research Paper Presentation — SITAMS

LEADERSHIP

Club Coordinator — Media Club, The Apollo University

- Coordinated university-wide events, partnering with faculty, students, and external professionals.
- Led execution of multiple campus-wide initiatives from planning through delivery.

SKILLS

Product: Product Discovery, Product Strategy, User Research, Competitive Analysis, Prioritization, Roadmapping, User Stories, Acceptance Criteria, MVP Planning, Product Documentation, Product Metrics

Product Design: Figma, Wireframing, User Journey Mapping, Personas, UX Thinking

AI & Technology: Python, SQL, JavaScript, React, OpenAI APIs, Prompt Engineering, LLMs, LangChain, Git, GitHub

Collaboration: Stakeholder Management, Cross-functional Collaboration, Documentation, Presentation, Problem Solving, Agile Fundamentals